

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in legal research, drafting and document management gained at BCLP, Q-Legal and Citizens Advice. Experienced in producing clear written analysis, organising and maintaining structured case materials, and translating complex legal and regulatory requirements into accessible outputs. Developing interest in financial markets and private equity work, followed up through independent study of fund structures, leverage and transactional mechanics. Accurate, organised and comfortable working to tight deadlines across competing matters.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation on data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules included Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Conducted legal research and drafted procedural histories, procedural orders and sections of the Claimant's memorial in a complex investment arbitration
- Became the sole junior supporting the team before a significant submission deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time filing
- Reviewed and organised large volumes of evidence for procedural submissions; maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes; wrote up findings for immediate use by fee-earners
- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Maintained matter records via iManage; assisted with court filings, deadline tracking and cost comparisons across several concurrent matters

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines across a varied caseload
- Interviews clients, takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues across welfare, employment, housing and debt matters
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; researches complex points; translates detailed rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals

Q-Legal · London**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Produced a formal written advice letter on UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Identified legal and compliance risks from the client's data processing and recommended practical mitigations in commercially focused, accessible language
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the agreed deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements; reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report and advice writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundles, procedural histories, structured case-file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters